

Plan living and reception spaces

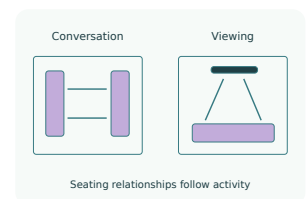
Living-space planning starts with people and activities. Compare conversation and viewing arrangements, testing circulation and access against explicit acceptance points.

What you will accomplish

- Define activities and seating relationships
- Test circulation during use
- Compare layouts using the same acceptance points

Define activities and seating relationships

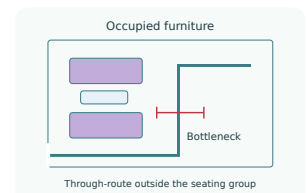
Record everyday and guest occupancy and priorities for conversation, viewing or reading. Conversation needs reciprocal sightlines; viewing needs a suitable orientation to the screen from the intended seats. Seat count alone does not establish usability. Draw sightlines and identify seats requiring an awkward turn for the requested activity; do not derive seating comfort from screen size.



Judge sightlines against the intended activity.

Test circulation during use

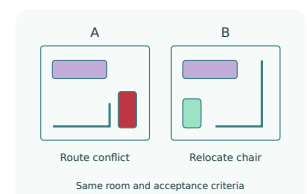
Map routes from the entrance to destinations, including open doors, moved chairs and table use. Where the brief allows, keep through-traffic outside the conversation group. Measure the narrowest point in realistic operating states and compare it with documented user and project requirements. A clearance copied from an image is not a universal rule or evidence of accessibility compliance.



Measure bottlenecks in occupied and opening states.

Compare layouts using the same acceptance points

Keep room boundaries and assumed occupancy fixed when comparing A for conversation with B for viewing. Assess sightlines, through-routes, door opening and table access using the same criteria. Record trade-offs rather than changing drawing scale to flatter a proposal. Floor markings and a simple use mock-up can test positions before selection; symmetry alone is not a functional pass.



Use common criteria and state the trade-off.

Worked case and decision

The family prioritises conversation and daily balcony access. A faces seats toward each other but places a chair in the balcony route. B moves the chair to the side while retaining visual connection. Prefer B subject to checking the narrowest route and balcony door operation on site; an extra seat must not reintroduce the conflict.

Decision: prefer B subject to route and door verification.

Check understanding

What makes the A/B comparison meaningful?

- Same boundaries, users and criteria
- Shrink furniture in the favoured option
- Judge symmetry alone

Correct: Same boundaries, users and criteria. Fixed assumptions expose real functional differences.

Lesson questions

Does symmetry prove a good layout?

No. Test activities, sightlines, routes and openings for the actual users.

Practice

Submit two same-scale layouts with activities, sightlines, circulation and acceptance criteria; justify the choice.

Users and activities

Two circulation plans

Criteria and trade-off

Review your work against the criteria. Saving it does not constitute technical project approval.

- Consistent assumptions
- Bottlenecks checked
- Priority-based decision